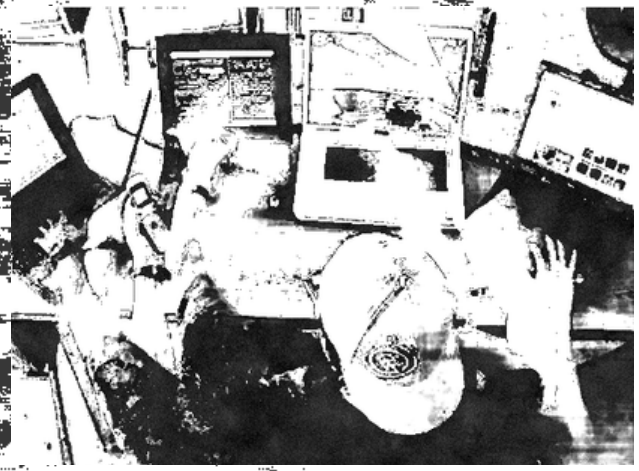
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#classifieds





stacker news
weekly zine

issue #75
oct 17 - oct 30



stacker news zine

by @plebpoet

note from the editor

the barista patiently,

quietly, waits for me

i snap a code once it's ready

now i get my coffee

zap.

receive-only lightning checkout: a hacked server can't drain your node

21.3k sats \ 19 comments \ **@rizful_com** 18 Oct lightning

Like a lot of you, we spent August 7 watching merchant Lightning nodes get swept. A bug in BTCPay Server let attackers pull LND macaroons off merchant servers without logging in. With those, they closed channels and walked off with the funds. Foundation, Citadel21, IVPN and others were hit. (IVPN's writeup is worth a read.)

To be clear, we love BTCPay Server. It has done more for merchant adoption than almost anything, and the team responded fast. But that week made something obvious that was always true: keeping a live, spend-capable Lightning node on the same internet-facing machine that runs your shop is fundamentally pretty scary.

So we built **OpenReceive** to take spending out of the picture entirely.

How it works

- Your app connects to your wallet with a **receive-only Nostr Wallet Connect (NWC) code**. That code can create invoices and list incoming payments. It cannot pay anyone.
- On startup, OpenReceive asks the wallet what the code is allowed to do. If the code advertises pay_invoice or any other spend method, the app refuses to start.
- There is no send path anywhere in the code.
- Worst case: your server gets owned and the code leaks. The attacker can generate invoices that pay you and read your payment history. They can't drain anything. Revoke the code and mint a new one.
- Your node doesn't have to live on the merchant box at all. NWC talks to it over a Nostr relay, so it can sit on separate hardware: Alby Hub, LNbits, or your own CLN node with a zero-budget NWC plugin. Rizful works too if you're small and want something simple.
- No accounts, no API keys, we never touch funds. MIT licensed and self-hosted.

> > >

...continued

Works with BTCPay Server, and makes it safer
You don't have to choose. There's an OpenReceive plugin in the BTCPay plugin directory (BTCPay 2.4.4+). Paste in a receive-only NWC code and your wallet becomes the store's Lightning node. BTCPay keeps doing what it's good at, including invoices, accounting, and the Woo/Odoo/Magento/PrestaShop integrations. The difference is that there's no node with spendable macaroons sitting on the server anymore. The tradeoff, by design: no Lightning payouts or refunds from that backend.

If you're not on BTCPay, there are drop-in libraries for Express, Fastify, Next.js, NestJS, FastAPI, Django, Flask, Rails, PHP/Laravel, plus a WooCommerce plugin.

Yes, about the stablecoins...
OpenReceive can optionally accept USDT and USDC (also SOL and ETH) through a swap provider you configure. The payment is swapped automatically to BTC over Lightning and settles in your wallet. The merchant never holds a stablecoin. They receive sats.

We did this because the reality is a lot of people want to pay with this. In a lot of the world, dollar stablecoins are how people actually hold and move money. We think the best way to bring Bitcoin adoption to those people is to have the merchants actually receive Lightning. Every one of those payments ends up as a bitcoin buy, and every merchant who turns it on is running a Lightning checkout.

If you don't want it, don't turn it on. Swaps are off unless you add a provider. One honest caveat: swaps add complexity, because a short or late deposit has to be refunded on the payer's chain. That flow is documented.

Links
- Docs: https://openreceive.org
- BTCPay plugin: https://openreceive.org/btcpay
- Source: https://github.com/OpenReceive/openreceive

We'd genuinely love for this crowd to try to break it. Tell us what we got wrong.

comments

202 sats \ 1 reply \ **@FunWithFreedomTech** 18 Oct
I'm using it. This is a great idea.

103 sats \ 1 reply \ **@06bc1a977d** 18 Oct
Good threat model. Spend keys never on the web box is the right call.

113 sats \ 4 replies \ **@Coinsreporter** 18 Oct
If it's recieve only, how would I ever transfer funds to spend?
Just asking coz it ain't clear by the article.

> 2 sats \ 3 replies \ **@rizful_com** OP 18 Oct
> Right. You withdraw/spend from your connected NWC wallet -- could be Alby Hub on your own machine, Alby Cloud, Rizful, or lots of other options -- see here:
> https://openreceive.org/get_a_nwc_code_to_receive_payments
> The point is, from the perspective of the "merchant website" -- where you actually take payments -- it's a one-way system where you can receive but not spend.
> Then you use a totally separate system to withdraw. It's a basic "separation of concerns" design, which in the end yields a merchant website which "can't be hacked"....

i finally visited pubkey in washington dc

15.8k sats \ 19 comments \
@siggy47 18 Oct bitcoin

I am attending a reunion of sorts of some old friends in DC. I had some free time yesterday, so I finally got the opportunity to visit the Washington Pubkey.

The Washington DC version of Pubkey is located on 7th Street in the Penn Quarter neighborhood of the city. It's not far from Ford's Theater and the J Edgar Hoover FBI building. Capital One Arena, where the Washington Capitals play, is down the block. It is an upscale, touristy location.

I have posted a few times about the NYC version. I have a great time whenever I go:
#219987
#230440
#1283387



>>>

...continued

Pubkey DC opened in January, 2026, according to the website,
but I thought it had been around longer. Yesterday the Washington Capitals had an early game, so there were plenty of fans in jerseys milling about. When I walked in I immediately noticed how different this place was from the New York version. It's huge, around 12,000 square feet, with two bars, a stage, and big screens everywhere showing sporting events. There was a good crowd, which looked to be a mix of tourists, locals, and hockey fans. I can't be certain, but I'm pretty sure I was the only person in the place interested in bitcoin.

This is not an in your face bitcoin space. I had just had a long car and was hungry. I decided to sit at the bar and have some lunch after exploring a bit.

At first I didn't notice much bitcoin stuff, but it is all strategically placed to fit in unobtrusively. I liked the low key design. It could be any sports /tourist spot in any city.

There were a few stickers in the men's room:



I then noticed a large wall display with some actively mining bitaxes:



And this small, but intriguing stack of bitcoin and bitcoin adjacent books below a "Free Samourai" sign:



When ordering my lunch I let the bartender know that I planned to pay in bitcoin. I was told that if I did, I would receive a 21% discount, which is impressive. I asked about the payment setup, and was a little disappointed that they just use square. I tried to.engage my server in a little bitcoin banter, but it was obvious he had no deep interest. I dont want to sound negative. All of the workers were friendly and competent. The menu was similar to the NYC Pubkey. I had a Caesar wrap, which was very good. I must say paying with the square app was quick and easy. You select the tip amount before the invoice is generated, which is nice. I have experienced a few awkward moments trying to tip at the NYC Pubkey. You never can be sure if the server would prefer sats or dollars. This way they probably get a choice.

That being said, paying with square is still disappointing.

I guess this proves there are some bitcoiners patronizing the place.

I didn't get to experience an event, but there is plenty of room for bitcoin gatherings. NYC Pubkey always feels a little cramped. I know Thomas Massie will be holding a discussion soon. I hope I get some time on my next trip to catch a presentation.



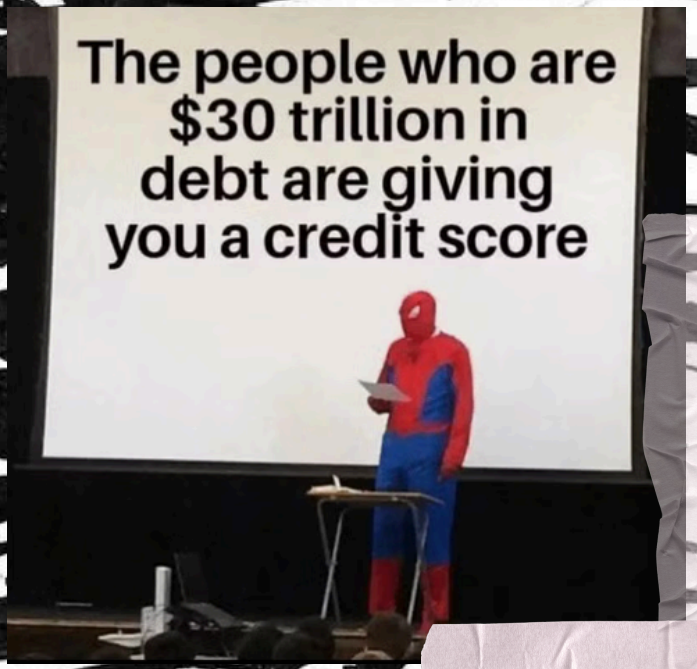
meme monday

253 sats \ 4 comments \ **@sn** 19 Oct memes

31 sats \ 0 replies \ @hasherstacker 26 oct



10 sats \ 0 replies \ @satoshisatsamoto 19 oct



should economists stay in their lane?

16.6k sats \ 29 comments \ **@ihatevake** 26 Oct econ

One of the interesting things about studying economics is how wide its applications are. Once you understand general principles like supply & demand, marginal cost/revenue, opportunity cost, comparative advantage, asymmetric information, and so forth, you can apply it to a wide varieties of subjects.



What this has led to, over time, is the "invasion" of other subjects by economists. A list of examples includes:

1. **Politics and Government**- Public choice theory is the study of how incentives affect the behavior of politicians, voters, and government employees. It's produced such foundational concepts as rent-seeking behavior, concentrated benefits & dispersed costs, rational ignorance, bureaucratic incentives, regulatory capture, and the political-business cycle.
2. **Law and Criminal Justice**- The incentives and tradeoffs inherent to plea bargaining, tort law, and litigation have all been studied extensively through an economic lens. Economist pioneered the concept of optimal deterrence (i.e. how much punishment effectively disincentives a crime, without going too extensive), and written extensively about the negative effects of drug prohibition.
3. **Sports**- Salary caps, the quantifiable effect of home field advantage, etc. all fit right into economics. The best-seller Freakonomics has a chapter about deliberate losses in sumo wrestling (when one party has already qualified for the next round of the tournament, but the other hasn't) that can be proven statistically.
4. **Healthcare**- Healthcare economics is a massive field, studying issues like moral hazard, adverse selections, and trends such as hospital consolidation.
5. **Military Strategy and War**- Military conflict is tightly intertwined with game theory. The bargaining theory of war, credible commitment, and other ideas can explain a nation's decision whether to enter or avoid conflict.
6. **Marriage, Family and Relationships**- Marriage and dating are, in essence, a market based on partner selection and matching. Household specialization can be seen as simple division of labor, and the choice to have children often depends on the opportunity cost of lost wages. Economists will even look at how changes in household income or laws affect divorce rates, or how data from dating apps demonstrate revealed preferences.

The list goes on and on: religion, sociology, biology, technology all have an economics angle. This has produced something of a superiority complex amongst economists. A 2005 survey of economics graduate students found 77% believe that economics is the most scientific of the social sciences. This can be because the mathematical models and empirical techniques used in economics generates more precise predictions than the tools used in political science, sociology and elsewhere, and is capable of distinguishing causal effects from mere correlation. Moreover, incentives are the root of human behavior and many of our actions can be explained by how they personally affect us.

However, this expansion of economics into other fields, sometimes termed "Economics Imperialism," has produced a backlash. Critics state that economists oversimplify human behavior, ignore research and scholarship elsewhere, and are trying to establish economics as the dominant social science. Sociologists claim "human beings are not merely utility maximizing individuals," and that treating them as purely independent decision-makers responding to incentives is misguided. For example, marriage isn't just a matching market with individuals looking to maximize utility; there's religious norms, romantic preferences, and family obligations to consider. Likewise, political scientists will say that politics is more than rational self-interest, and healthcare experts argue patients are not just units in a cost-benefit calculation. In response to the criticism, some economists claim that other academics are threatened by economics purely out of selfish protectionism and hostility to novel theories that challenge their field's internal dogma.

So, the question I ask of you is: should economists stay in their lane?



comments

277 sats \ 2 replies \ **@SimpleStacker** 26 Oct
I'd argue both yes and no.

On the "no" side, I'd say that economists have objectively the most rational approach to thinking about social science (1. Identify the players; 2. Identify their incentives and constraints; 3. Assess the behavior that results), as well as having the most sophisticated tools for separating causality from correlation.

On the "yes" side, I'd say that economists sometimes put too much trust in their tools than is warranted. Although their tools are correct, there are always some simplifying assumptions that are made---those simplifying assumptions are sometimes quite important and economists often fail to recognize that. They are sometimes blinded to common sense and traditional wisdom because of that. They may be too quick to devalue common sense approaches that don't have solid empirical evidence behind them. ...

the long road to bitcoin payments...



51k sats \ 66 comments \ **@spiral** 27 Oct bitcoin

Why bitcoin payments haven't taken off, and a call for moonshot ideas that could change that

"If [bitcoin] ends up just being digital gold, I think it's failed," Jack Dorsey said in January 2025. "If it ends up being a currency that people can use daily, then it's succeeded." Not everyone agrees. Many in bitcoin argue it must first succeed as a store of value, and that demand for payments will follow. So we start with a clear question: does the current path lead to irrelevance, or is it the expected grind of hardening bitcoin for the day it's needed for payments? This report asks what is holding bitcoin payments back, and what moonshot ideas could speed up adoption.

Bitcoin payments work better than ever. Turning that progress into everyday use remains the challenge, and the time to move is now, as stablecoins are ready to gain rapid adoption.

Where things stand. Over the past seven years, bitcoin spending technology has improved dramatically. Lightning infrastructure runs in production, and self-custodial wallets now hide most of their complexity. Seven years ago, building a bitcoin payments app took more than a year and several developers. Today, anyone can build a working first version from a single prompt to an AI coding tool. Custodial bitcoin is now no harder to integrate than custodial stablecoins, though self-custodial bitcoin is still harder to run at scale. More than a million US merchants can accept bitcoin through Square. Yet few people pay with bitcoin in everyday life, a point most in the industry accept. The gap is mostly demand, not technology.

Why now. The wider financial system is being updated, raising an open question: will the rails chosen during this shift be hard to change later, or will payments follow what people want to pay and be paid in, with software making it easy to add any payment rail? As large payment providers update their rails, they are choosing stablecoins, not bitcoin. Stripe, Shopify and Coinbase are building stablecoins in, and major consumer products appear likely to follow. Stripe, Visa, American Express and Google have also joined a consortium launching a new stablecoin, OUSD, and the first protocol implementations for AI agent payments settle almost entirely in stablecoins. Developers build on the rails their tools support, and wallets ship with the networks their partners already use. AI agents are the clearest case. They need small, programmable payments, which Lightning suits, yet the first agent payment tools are being built around stablecoins and cards. If early choices do stick, bitcoin's absence now could be hard to reverse. If they don't, the question becomes demand alone.

What's blocking it?

- **Demand**: neither side is pulling for it. Holders would rather save than spend, and bitcoin's culture celebrates holding. Merchants prefer to receive and hold dollars, so few accept bitcoin, and new payment platforms leave it out.
- **Volatility and competition**: price swings make bitcoin hard to price goods in, and dollar stablecoins meet the need for stable payments.
- **Policy**: US tax treatment of every purchase and pending regulation.

What could change this? We're looking for moonshot ideas: changes big enough to shift bitcoin payments, not just improve them. A few possible paths to start the discussion:

- **Shared rails**: let people pay in dollars or bitcoin over the same Lightning network, with a compelling reason to choose it, so bitcoin is one tap away wherever people already pay: in agent payments, merchant checkout and fintech apps.
- **Payments for people who need them most**: self-custodial bitcoin payments that better solve the needs of people facing capital controls or unstable currencies.
- **New reasons to spend**: spending incentives for existing holders.
- **New ways to spend**: product experiences that create entirely new kinds of payments, such as paying creators or AI services per use. The killer app for micropayments probably won't feel like a traditional payment at all.

We don't know which, if any, will work. That's why we want to hear yours.

What we're asking. Our central question: what moonshot ideas would create a believable, viable plan to accelerate bitcoin payments adoption? To make it explicit: what would it take for a major platform such as Meta, Shopify, or OpenAI to accept bitcoin? Builders: propose ideas and test them. Payment providers: share data on how people pay. Funders: back the most promising experiments and help foster demand. This is a living document. Read the full report on GitHub, share your ideas or data in the replies below, or join the GitHub discussion. We'll keep updating the report as we learn.

trip report: hong kong

21.3k sats \ 12 comments \ **@leo** 29 Oct Travel

Hong Kong will always have a very special place in my heart. I spent about half of my adulthood there and am still very fond of the place and its people. I argue that around 2014-2018, Hong Kong was the most important city in the world for Bitcoin trading, and exchanges like BTCC, Binance, Bitfinex, Bitmex, Crypto,com, FTX, OKX, and many others have called Hong Kong their home at some point. The second Bitcoin ATM was installed at a Hong Kong bar called "Bitpoint," where one of the oldest still functional Bitcoin meetups convened regularly.

Today, the community is still somewhat there, but Hong Kong no longer plays an important role in Bitcoin globally. There are no relevant exchanges left, no large-scale events of global appeal, there are no noticeable startups, and I'm not aware of any exciting tech coming out of the city. However, I'm very positively surprised to see the local merchant economy is once again growing, particularly among the struggling bars, and so I refilled my Lightning wallet and went out to find them.

🪙Hongkongers have only limited access to apps and websites that let them buy Bitcoin with Hong Kong dollars, but it's still very easy to buy and sell Bitcoin with cash. There are dozens if not hundreds of in-person OTC brokerages around, many in prominent locations. In 2024 I wrote about a single mall that hosts 11 brokers alone. This time I'm heading to OneSatoshi in Chungking Mansions, partly because I expect them to accept deposits over Lightning, and partly because Chungking Mansions, the Ghetto at the Center of the World is such an insanely cool place. Here, in five blocks with 17 stories each you can find pretty much anyone doing anything, especially if it has to do with trade with Africa, India or the Middle East. At the counter I ask for a quote to sell Bitcoin over the Lightning Network, 5000 HKD. I'm asked to pay 462,881 satoshi, but first the woman behind the counter asks me to show my "Lightning address," so she can check if my funds are clean. I have to correct her that this is not how Lightning payments work, and she admits to never having witnessed one. She asks me to wait for a few minutes as she checks with her boss. As I wait I am approached by a man identifying himself as from India, who is visiting Chungking Mansions to buy refurbished iPhones that he will resell back home. He intends to pay for these phones with cash proceeds from selling his BNB, which he holds in his Binance wallet. He gets a quote, inquires about the process and vows to come back the next day. Meanwhile my situation has been somewhat resolved, as I am shown a photo of a Binance wallet, with a QR code of a Lightning invoice. I pay the invoice, which takes my node about thirty seconds for a 1149 satoshi fee. Once I pay I ask the clerk to check with her boss, who tells her over Telegram that my deposit was made and that she can pay out the cash. The woman seems deeply impressed over the speed, as usually it takes about 30-60 minutes until onchain funds are received and payouts can be made. She asks me why not more people are using Lightning, and I tell her that it's "still early." I calculate my fees and figure I paid about a 3% fee over the market rate for the service. I'm quite happy about that, and I know a bank debit card would charge you about the same, depending on the amount.

👔Just across the street from Chungking Mansions, on the 8th floor of a thin older building I find **Montaj Tailors** on BTCMap. They are co-located with a company specializing in trading luxury cars, and a jewellery company, and all accept Bitcoin payments. I walk in without an appointment, and after a short wait my measurements are taken. I choose the fabric and styles and order three shirts, for HK$3000 plus a $500 shipping fee. When it comes to paying the owner admits to have never taken a Bitcoin transaction, and that he would have to contact the person signing him up. No problem, as I won't be able to take my shirts with me right away anyway. I later message that person myself and learn there is a 20% discount for members of the Bitcoin Association of Hong Kong. That's great, as I am a member, so when my $3500 (~US$446) invoice finally arrives together with a Blink Lightning Address, I ask about it and request a fourth shirt. Now I'm quoted HK$4500 for four shirts (instead of $3700), and stupidly enough I'm on a bus as I get the email, so I do not double check as I dispatch the payment. After a short reclamation I am offered a fifth shirt, significantly more than I originally came for. After about two weeks the shirts arrive by mail in Canada, plus a US$43 surcharge for taxes, duties and fees. The embroidered Bitcoin symbols came out really well and I'm content with the quality.

☕Right at the heart of the newly renovated Central Market is **Chart Coffee**, a small coffee shop primarily serving the many commuters passing through this building on their way from the Mid-levels Escalator to the ferries, trams and trains intersecting nearby. Chart Coffee sports their many prizes and medals next to their "We Accept Bitcoin" sign. The barista handles my payment swiftly, but the process still feels a bit clunky, as they have to log into their OpenNode web interface to generate a QR code for me. ...

< cont. online >



This bar does not take Bitcoin.

This bar takes bitcoin. Make it make sense.

